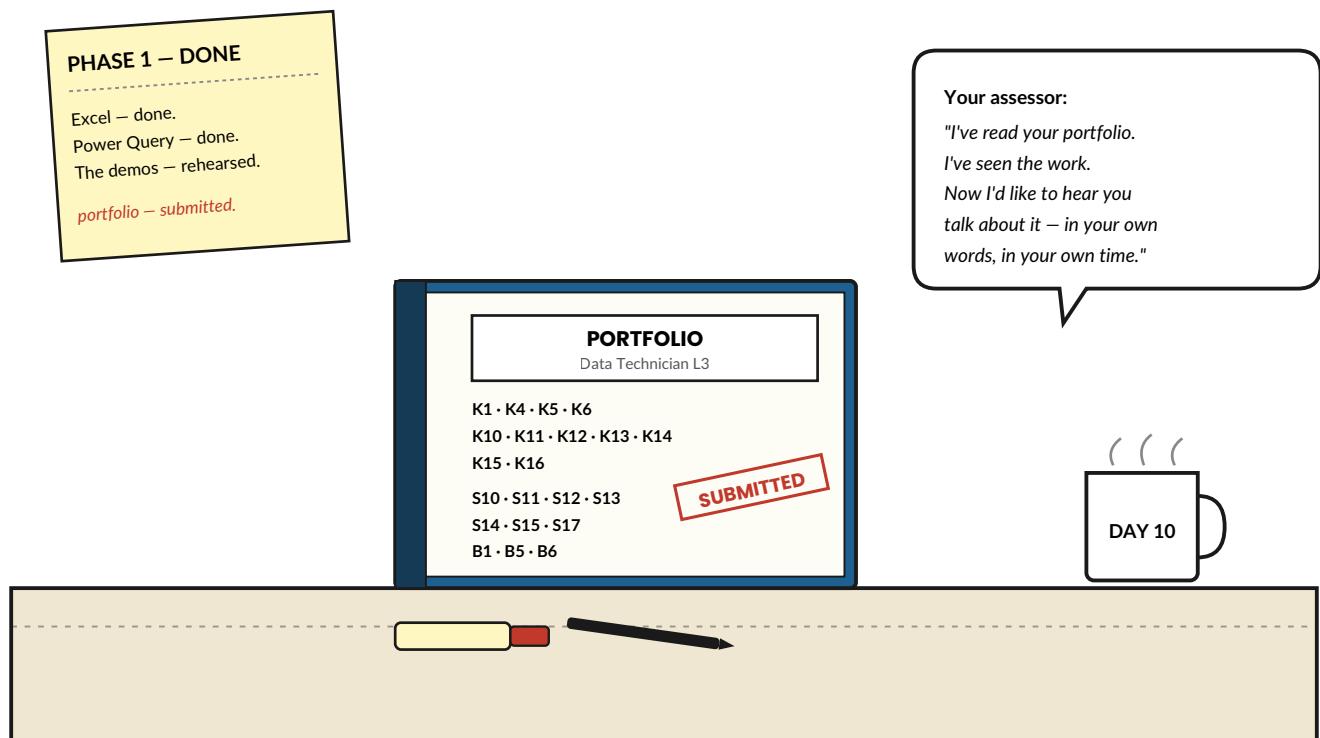


10

phase two starts here

Your Portfolio Is Already Written

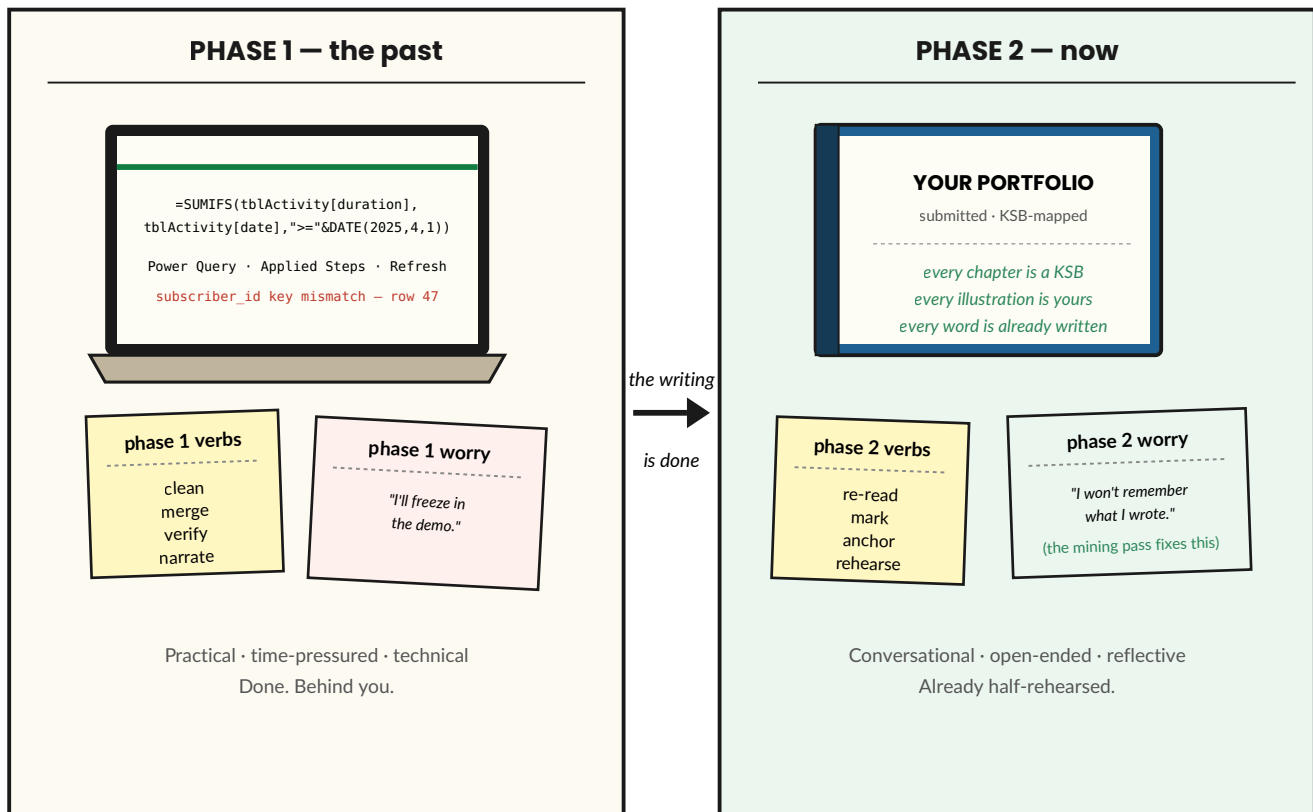
8 days · 1 hour a day · the writing is done — the rehearsal starts now



Take a breath. The hardest part is already done. Your portfolio is submitted; the assessor has it. The next 8 days are rehearsal — turning the words you already wrote into strong, defensible spoken answers in a 60-minute conversation.

What changed

Phase 1 was a practical workout against a fictional brief. Phase 2 is conversation, anchored to *your* real workplace portfolio — already submitted, already read.



It's rehearsal, not revision

The writing is done.

Now we make it speakable.

You will **not**

- revise your portfolio
- add new evidence
- invent material

The deadline has passed; the document is locked.

You will

- re-read it strategically
- convert stories to STARR (Day 11)
- rehearse until it flows

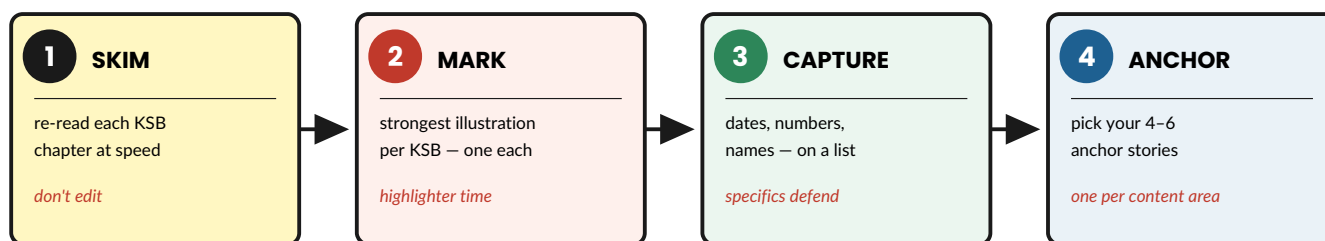
Repetition is the whole technique.

SHOW THIS OFF

Every defensible answer ties back to something already in writing. When you say "*in my portfolio I covered this under K6 – the example I used was...*" the assessor doesn't have to take your word for it. **Pass-level candidates answer. Distinction-level candidates anchor.**

The Portfolio Mining Pass

A structured re-read of your own portfolio. **Four steps. About 90 minutes.** You come out the other end with a marked-up copy and the beginnings of your *anchor stories*.

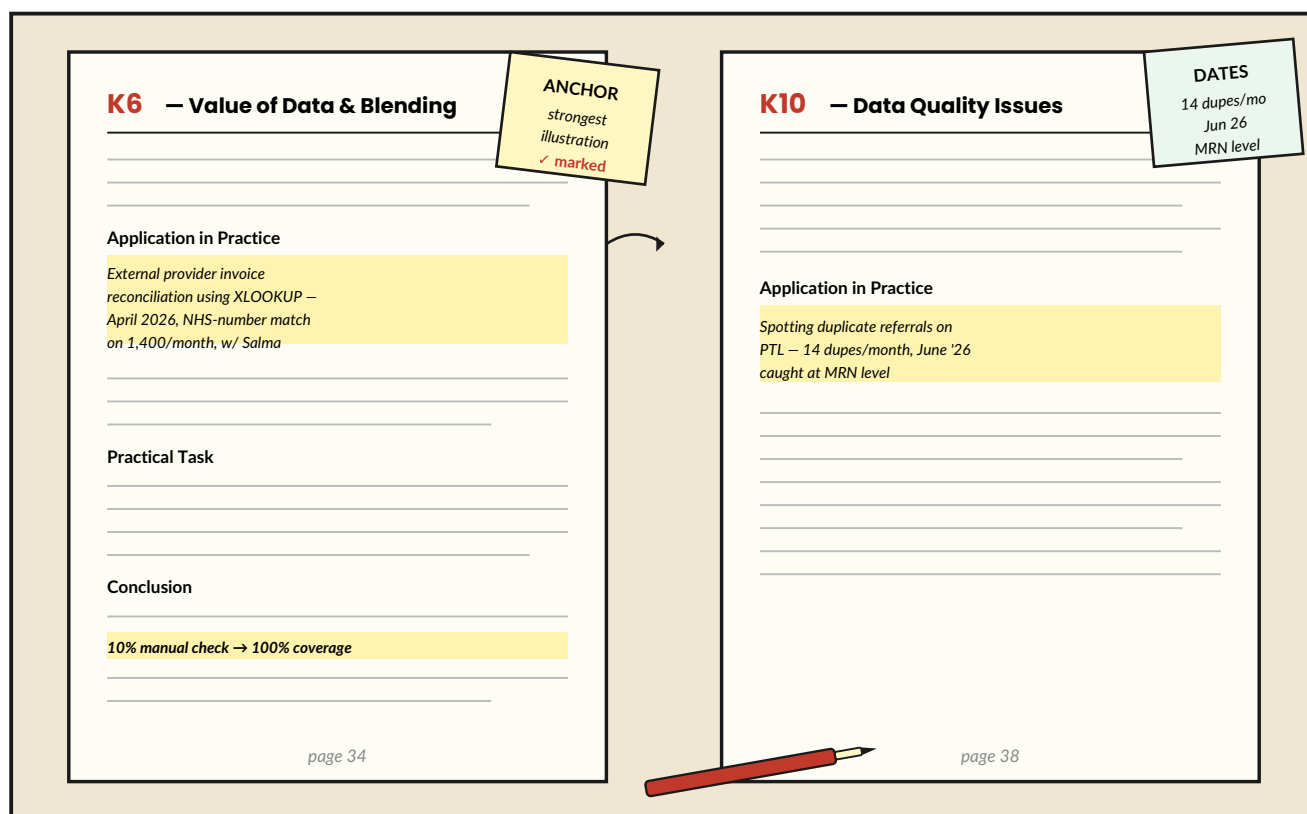


ASSESSOR FAVOURITE

The Mining Pass is not optional. Apprentices who skip it walk into the discussion trying to recall content cold. Apprentices who do it walk in knowing exactly which story to reach for — and that confidence is audible.

The Mining Pass — in action

Open the document. Pen and highlighter beside you. Don't edit; mark. Below: what one page looks like after a Mining Pass session.



What makes an illustration strong

When you're marking on the Mining Pass, you're looking for these three. Two-out-of-three is acceptable; one alone is not.



1 • A RESULT

Something *changed*:
a number moved, a process
improved, a problem caught



2 • SPECIFICS

Named dates, named
numbers, named people.
Specifics signal authenticity.

1	2	3	4
---	---	---	---

3 • A STORY

You can replay it
beat-by-beat: first X,
then Y, then Z.

SHOW THIS OFF

The illustration with all three traits is your anchor story. The brilliant prose without specifics? Skip it. *Specifics defend; prose decorates*. Pick the messier, specific one every time.

Your four anchor stories

From the strong illustrations you mark, four to six become your **anchors**. **At least one per content area** the discussion covers.

Content area	An anchor story that fits
Data Gathering K1 · K4 · K6 · K15	A project where you picked which data sources to use — and one you decided <i>not</i> to use, with the reason.
Data Analysis & Validation K10 · K11	Work where you found a data quality issue — duplicates, mismatched keys, nulls, outliers — and what you did about it.
Distribution & Dissemination K5 · K12 · K13 · K14 · S10–S13	A moment where you communicated the same analysis to two different audiences — technical peer vs manager, internal vs external.
Approach to Work K16 · S14 · S15 · S17 · B1 · B5 · B6	A stakeholder pressure moment, a deadline you managed, or a learning episode where something didn't go well and you adjusted.



BRAIN POWER

Before Day 11, name one candidate per content area. Just names — *"PTL project · invoice reconciliation · dashboard for booking lead · the October deadline crunch."*

Don't polish them yet.

What your assessor already has

Before the 60 minutes start, three things are already on their desk. Which means the discussion is not about *whether* you did the work — it's about you talking about it.

What your assessor has — before the discussion starts

1. Your portfolio

K11 — Validating Data

application: PTL data quality

they've read every chapter

2. The KSB mapping

CHAPTER MAP

K1pp 7–18✓

K4pp 19–26✓

K5pp 27–32✓

K6pp 33–36✓

K10pp 36–43✓

K11pp 36–43✓

K12pp 45–47✓

... and so on for every KSB

they know which pages to open

3. Question shapes

D1 — gathering

"Walk me through why this data set..."

D2 — comms

"How did you adapt for the audience?"

D3 — storage

"Justify your storage and ethics choices."

prepared in advance

SO THE DISCUSSION ISN'T A TEST OF WHETHER YOU DID THE WORK.

The assessor has already seen that. The discussion is for them to hear **you** explain it, judge it, and reflect on it — the things the written portfolio explicitly doesn't include.

It's conversation, not cross-examination.

Chapter 10

you are here 8

What happens to your discussion

Three short facts that settle the most common format-worries.

Remote

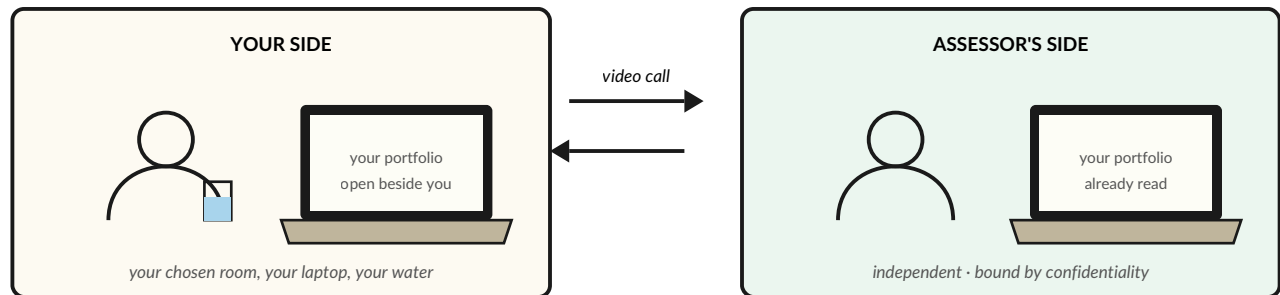
Held via video conferencing — Teams, Zoom, or similar. You're in a quiet room of your choosing. Water on the desk; notes visible to you; no travel.

Moderation only

Audio is recorded so the EPAO can moderate consistency and handle appeals. Not played back to anyone else. Destroyed after the retention period.

Independent

The assessor is bound by EPAO confidentiality. Not affiliated with your employer. Your manager doesn't watch; colleagues don't see the portfolio.



Halfway House

Five quick questions. Answer in your head first; check below.

1. My Phase 2 job is to revise and improve my portfolio.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

2. The assessor has not read my portfolio — they read it as we go.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

3. A strong illustration has a result, specifics, and a story I can replay beat-by-beat.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

4. If I can't remember a detail mid-answer, my best move is to invent something plausible.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

5. The professional discussion is held at my employer's premises, in person.

☐ **True** ☐ **False**

Answers

1. **False.** Portfolio is locked; your Phase 2 job is rehearsal.
2. **False.** The assessor has read it in advance and cross-referenced KSBs against the standard.
3. **True.** All three traits; two-of-three is acceptable; one alone is not.
4. **False.** The Day 9 bluff warning still applies — *"I'd want to check that detail..."* beats invention.
5. **False.** The discussion is remote, via video conferencing.



SHARPEN YOUR PENCIL 90 minutes — do this *before* Day 11

Open your portfolio. For each KSB chapter, fill one row. *Don't edit — mark and note.*

KSB	Strongest illustration (1 line)	Date	Numbers / names / result
eg K6	Invoice reconciliation, XLOOKUP on NHS no.	Apr 26	1,400/mo; Salma; 10% → 100% coverage
K1			
K4			
K5			
K6			
K10			
K11			
K12			
K13			
K14			
K15			
K16			
S10			
S11			
S12			
S13			
S14			
S15			
S17			
B1			
B5			
B6			

Half tonight, half tomorrow is fine. By Day 11: most rows filled, four anchors circled.

There are no *Dumb* Questions

Q: *What if I can't remember the project I wrote about?*

A: That's exactly what the Mining Pass fixes — you re-read your own words with the dates and numbers in front of you, and the memory comes back. If a section still feels distant, talk to the colleague you worked with on it.

Q: *I included something in the portfolio that I'm not actually proud of. Hide it?*

A: No — reflect on it. The Distinction descriptors reward apprentices who can evaluate their own work critically. *"In hindsight I'd have done this differently because..."* is exactly the move that scores. Day 16 will rehearse it.

Q: *What if one KSB in my portfolio is barely covered?*

A: The assessor has already read it and decided to assess on what's there. They may probe a thin section in the discussion — that's an opportunity to fill it verbally, not a trap.

Q: *The assessor asks something and my mind goes blank. What now?*

A: Standard recovery: *"Could I take a moment to pull up that chapter in my portfolio?"* Take 15 seconds, find the page, answer from there. Asking for a moment is professional, not failure.

Q: *I've changed my mind about how I wrote something. Can I correct it?*

A: Yes — and it often scores. *"On reflection, what I wrote in K12 understated the challenge; what actually happened was..."* shows reflective thinking, which is what the discussion is for.

Q: *What if they ask about something I never wrote about?*

A: Fully normal. The assessor isn't limited to the portfolio. Describe the real workplace example verbally and tie it to the KSB out loud. **The one answer to avoid: "I don't do that" or "I have no evidence".** That's the major-fault answer — immediate Refer on the criterion. Always reframe instead: *"I haven't led on that, but I've supported it by..."* or *"I haven't covered that directly, but the principle I'd apply is..."*

Mine, mark, anchor.

What's already there is already enough.

Say it for real

Practise these out loud. The first time will feel slow; by the third pass, it flows.

Q1 – Tell me about your portfolio in 90 seconds.

The shape: role & workplace → KSB structure → two-or-three strongest illustrations by name → what they collectively show.

Try: "I'm a data technician in [team] at [organisation]. My portfolio is structured by KSB – each chapter covers one. The illustrations I'm most likely to talk about today are [story 1], [story 2] and [story 3]. Between them they cover most of the four content areas."

Q2 – Which piece of work are you most proud of, and why?

The shape: pick one anchor story → name what made it hard → name the result → land on what it taught you about the work, not about yourself.

Q3 – What's one thing in your portfolio you'd change now?

The shape: pick something specific → show thinking that's developed since you wrote it. This scores particularly well at distinction level – it *evaluates* your own work, which is what D2 asks for.

SHOW THIS OFF

The word *portfolio* should appear in the first 30 seconds of your opening answer – not vaguely, but as a concrete anchor: *"in my portfolio, in the K6 chapter, I described..."* Signals to the assessor: grounded, defensible, same page.

Bullet Points — the chapter in 30 seconds

- **The writing is done.** Phase 2 is rehearsal, not creation.
- **The Portfolio Mining Pass.** Skim, Mark, Capture, Anchor — in that order.
- **Strong illustrations have three traits.** A result, specifics, a beat-by-beat story. Two-of-three minimum.
- **Four anchor stories, one per content area.** Most discussion questions hit at least one.
- **The assessor has the portfolio, the mapping, and the question shapes.** The discussion isn't about whether you did the work.
- **Defensible answers anchor.** "*In my portfolio in chapter X I described...*" is the opening move.
- **No bluffing.** Reach for the portfolio mid-answer; never invent.

TEST DRIVE

Tick each only when it's true:

- ☐ You've completed the Mining Pass on at least half your KSB chapters.
- ☐ You've marked one strongest illustration per KSB you've covered.
- ☐ You've named at least one anchor story per content area.
- ☐ For each anchor, you have a date, a number, and a named person.
- ☐ You've said "*in my portfolio in chapter [KSB] I described...*" out loud, at least once.

COMING UP — DAY 11

STARR. The answer shape for every spoken question. Five layers — *Situation, Task, Action, Result, Reflection*. Tomorrow we take the anchor stories you marked today and walk each one through STARR until the cadence feels natural. The only new technique you need for AM2 — learned once, used every day after.

that's Day 10 done — the heavy lifting is already behind you.